

SABINA PARVIN

Dhaka, Bangladesh | sabinakakoli@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/sabina-parvin-0224b3145](https://www.linkedin.com/in/sabina-parvin-0224b3145)

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Results-driven Gender Specialist with over 13 years of progressive experience mainstreaming gender equality and women's empowerment across multilateral sovereign and non-sovereign operations. Expert in gender strategy and planning, Country Gender Assessments, gender action plans (GEN/EGM/SGE tagging), GBV/SEA/SH risk management, and knowledge leadership aligned with ADB's Strategy 2030 and the Gender Equality Division's mandate. Demonstrated capacity to provide technical inputs across project preparation and implementation, lead high-quality knowledge products, design and deliver capacity-building programs for government and CSO partners, and build strategic institutional partnerships with governments, UN agencies, bilateral donors, trust funds, and civil society. Experienced in donor relations, budget management, and portfolio-wide gender results monitoring across South and Southeast Asia — with international field experience across multiple countries in disaster risk management and humanitarian response.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Gender Mainstreaming & Tagging (GEN/EGM/SGE)	GBV / SEA / SH Risk Management	Sovereign & Non-Sovereign Operations
Country Gender Assessments & CPF Inputs	Knowledge Products & Research Leadership	Capacity Building & Training Design
Gender Results Monitoring & Reporting	Policy Influence & Strategic Advocacy	Donor Relations & Budget Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The World Bank, South Asia Region (Bangladesh & Bhutan) | Dhaka **Social Development Specialist – Gender & GBV** (April 2020 – April 2026)

- Provided senior technical leadership across 50+ sovereign operations, achieving 100% corporate gender tagging compliance.
- Developed actionable Gender Action Plans to close gender gaps aligned with World Bank Strategy and ADB-equivalent standards.
- Co-led the UFGE Trust Fund, managing research on women's economic opportunities in agriculture and workplace SEA/SH risks.
- Delivered capacity-building programs on gender mainstreaming and GBV risk management for task teams, UN agencies, and civil society.
- Co-authored the Country Gender Assessment Bangladesh 2022 to inform the Bangladesh CPF.
- Acted as gender focal across health, education, WASH, and infrastructure sectors.

UNFPA Bangladesh | Cox's Bazar & Dhaka National Office **GBViE Humanitarian Programme Officer** (January 2018 – December 2019)

- Led the design and implementation of a \$50M+ multi-donor gender and GBV portfolio covering 900,000+ Rohingya refugees and host communities.
- Influenced the Government of Bangladesh's Cyclone Preparedness Programme to adopt a policy mandating 50% female volunteers in leadership positions.

Plan International Bangladesh | Dhaka

Unit Head (Acting), Disaster Risk Management Unit (September 2017 – December 2017)

- Designed new gender-sensitive initiatives and provided interim leadership for DRM programming during the Rohingya emergency.

Specialist – Resilience & Social Inclusion (December 2016 – September 2017)

- Led advocacy with government counterparts to mainstream gender and social safeguards into national disaster risk reduction frameworks.

Project Manager – DIPECHO VIII Consortium (October 2015 – November 2016)

- Managed technical oversight of consortium knowledge management and supported guidelines for Education in Emergencies.

EARLIER RELEVANT ASSIGNMENTS

- Gender Consultant: Training on Gender and ESF for WB/ADB-funded government projects (May 2026–Present).
- Gender Consultant: Social Development Direct UK (2022); Triple R Alliance Canada / Duncan Brothers (2022).
- Gender Expert / Lead Consultant: CARE Bangladesh (2021); German Red Cross / Dhaka South City Corporation (2021).
- Project Coordinator: DIPECHO VII – SEEP (2013–2015).
- District Coordinator: Election & Governance Project – The Asia Foundation (2007–2009).

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Disaster Management

University of Dhaka, Bangladesh | Specialization: Gender, Resilience & Humanitarian Response

KNOWLEDGE PRODUCTS & PUBLICATIONS

- Co-Author: Country Gender Assessment Bangladesh 2022 (World Bank).
- Co-Designer: Research Initiative on Women's Economic Opportunities in Agriculture (UFGE Trust Fund, World Bank).
- Developer: Gender Action Plans and mainstreaming toolkits for 50+ sovereign operations in Bangladesh and Bhutan.
- Co-Designer: GBV-Sensitive GRM Operational Guidelines applied across South Asia.

ACCREDITATIONS, AWARDS & TRAINING

- Accreditations: World Bank Environmental and Social Standards (ESS); Regional Gender TAG Assessor, World Bank.
- Awards: World Bank Above and Beyond Awards (2025); VPU Team Awards for Health and Gender Support project (2021, 2023).
- International Training: World Bank IPF Training, Thailand (2026); SAR Mini Masters Programme (2026); SIDA/MSB Disaster Risk Management, Sweden (2019); UNFPA Managing GBV in Emergencies, Jordan (2018).
- Academic Delivery: Delivered master's-level modules at Dhaka University and Chittagong University of Engineering & Technology.

LANGUAGES

- English: Full professional proficiency (written and verbal)
- Bengali: Native